

A&E Performance in England: A Two-Year Picture

April 2023 – March 2025 | Prepared by Prem Shah | 01 August 2026 | Source: NHS England A&E Attendances and Emergency Admissions (published statistics)

This summary pulls together two years of published NHS England A&E data — covering 207 trusts and over 4,700 monthly records — to answer a simple question: how is A&E performance changing, and how does Northumbria Healthcare compare to the rest of the country?

58.8% National average seen within 4 hours (target: 95%)	74.4% Northumbria Healthcare average seen within 4 hours	6th Northumbria's national ranking out of 207 trusts	+137% Rise in patients waiting over 12 hours, Apr 2023 to Jan 2025
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What the data shows

- **The national 4-hour target is being missed by a wide margin.** Against the 95% standard, trusts in England have averaged 58.8% over the last two years — a gap of more than 36 percentage points. Performance has barely moved between the two years (58.6% to 59.0%).
- **Long waits are getting worse, not better.** The number of patients waiting over 12 hours in A&E rose from around 26,000 a month in April 2023 to about 61,500 a month by January 2025. Across the two years, annual 12-hour waits increased from roughly 439,000 to 532,000.
- **Northumbria Healthcare is one of the strongest performers in the country.** It averaged 74.4% of patients seen within 4 hours — 15.6 percentage points above the national average — and ranks 6th out of 207 trusts nationally.
- **Performance varies significantly by region.** The South East recorded the best average performance (62.2%), while the North West recorded the weakest (56.0%), pointing to underlying regional pressure differences rather than a single nationwide cause.

What this means

The national trend points to a system under sustained pressure, with long-wait patients — the group most closely linked to patient safety risk — growing fastest. Northumbria's sustained outperformance against this backdrop suggests local practices are working well and may be worth documenting and sharing more widely across the region.

Methodology: analysis of 24 months of publicly available NHS England A&E statistics (Apr 2023 – Mar 2025), cleaned and validated with automated data-quality checks (missing values, logical consistency, outlier detection) before analysis. Full pipeline, queries and code: github.com/Anon307/nhs-ae-analysis